ArchiMate® 3.1

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Business layer

Business Actor
A business entity that is capable of performing behavior

Business Collaboration
An aggregate of two or more business internal active structure elements that work together to perform collective behavior

Business Service
An explicitly defined behavior that a business role, business actor, or business collaboration exposes to its environment

Business Interaction
A unit of collective business behavior performed by (a collaboration of) two or more business actors, roles, or business collaboartions

Business Event
An organizational state change

Business Object
A concept used within a particular business domain

Representation
A perceptible form of the information carried by a b. object

Business Role
A responsibility for performing specific behavior, to which an actor can be assigned, or the part an actor plays in a particular action or event.

Business Interface
A point of access where a business service is made available to the environment

Business Process
A sequence of business behaviors that achieves a specific result such as a defined set of products or business services

Business Function
A collection of business behavior based on a chosen set of criteria (typically required business resources and/or competences)

Product
A coherent collection of services and/or passive structure elements, accompanied by a contract/set of agreements, which is offered as a whole to customers

Contract
A formal or informal specification of an agreement between a provider and a consumer that specifies the rights and obligations associated with a product and establishes functional and non-functional parameters for interaction

Strategy elements

Capability
An ability that an active structure element, such as an organization, person, or system, possesses

Value Stream
Sequence of activities that create an overall result for a customer, stakeholder or end user

Resource
An asset owned or controlled by an individual or organization

Course of Action
An approach or plan for configuring some capabilities and resources of the enterprise, undertaken to achieve a goal

Application layer

Application Component
An encapsulation of application functionality aligned to implementation structure, which is modular and replaceable.

Application Collaboration
An aggregate of two or more application internal active structure elements that work together to perform collective application behavior.

Application Service
An explicitly defined exposed application behavior

Application Interaction
A unit of collective application behavior performed by (a collaboration of) two or more application components

Application Event
An application state change

Data Object
Data structured for automated processing

Application Interface
A point of access where application services are made available to a user, another application component, or a node

Application Process
A sequence of application behaviors that achieves a specific result

Application Function
An automated behavior that can be performed by an application component

Motivation elements

Stakeholder
The role of an individual, team, or organization (or classes thereof) that represents their interests in the effects of the architecture

Driver
An external or internal condition that motivates an organization to define its goals and implement the changes necessary to achieve them

Assessment
The result of an analysis of the state of affairs of the enterprise with respect to some driver

Goal
A high-level statement of intent, direction, or desired end state for an organization and its stakeholders

Outcome
An end result

Principle
A statement of intent defining a general property that applies to any system in a certain context in the architecture

Requirement
A statement of need defining a property that applies to a specific system as described by the architecture

Constraint
A factor that limits the realization of goals

Meaning
The knowledge or expertise present in, or the interpretation given to, a concept in a particular context

Value
The relative worth, utility, or importance of a concept

Technology layer

Node
A computational or physical resource that hosts, manipulates, or interacts with other computational or physical resources

Technology Collaboration
An aggregate of two or more technology internal active structure elements that work together to perform collective technology behavior

Technology Service
An explicitly defined exposed technology behavior

Technology Interaction
A unit of collective technology behavior performed by (a collaboration of) two or more nodes

Technology Event
A technology state change

Artifact
A piece of data that is used or produced in a software development process, or by deployment and operation of an IT system

Device
A physical IT resource upon which system software and artifacts may be stored or deployed for execution

Technology Interface
A point of access where technology services offered by a node can be accessed

Technology Process
A sequence of technology behaviors that achieves a specific result

Technology Function
A collection of technology behavior that can be performed by a node

System Software
Software that provides or contributes to an environment for storing, executing, and using software or data deployed within it

Path
A link between two or more nodes, through which these nodes can exchange data, energy or material

Communication Network
A set of structures that connects nodes for transmission, routing, and reception of data

Physical elements

Equipment
One or more physical machines, tools, or instruments that can create, use, store, move, or transform materials

Facility
A physical structure or environment

Distribution Network
A physical network used to transport materials or energy

Material
Tangible physical matter or energy

Implementation and Migration elements

Work Package
A series of actions identified and designed to achieve specific results within specified time and resource constraints

Deliverable
A precisely-defined outcome of a work package

Implementation Event
A state change related to implementation or migration

Plateau
A relatively stable state of the architecture that exists during a limited period of time

Gap
A statement of difference between two plateaus

Relationships

Structural
Composition
Assignment
Aggregation
Realization

Dependency
Serving
Access
+/-
Influence
Association

Dynamic
Triggering
Flow

Other
Specialization

Relationship Connectors
Junction (and)
Junction (or)

Composite elements

Location
A place or position where structure elements can be located or behavior can be performed

Grouping
Aggregates or composes concepts that belong together based on some common characteristic

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